

Q1. Answer the following questions.

(i) What is agriculture?

Ans. The art and science of cultivation of soils, raising crops and rearing livestock is known as agriculture. The word agriculture is derived from Latin words 'ager' or 'agri' meaning soil and 'culture' meaning cultivation.

(ii) Name the factors influencing agriculture.

Ans. The factors influencing agriculture are favourable topography of soil and climate.

(iii) What is shifting cultivation? What are its disadvantages?

Ans. Shifting cultivation is an agricultural practice in which a patch of forest land is cleared by felling the trees and burning them. Then the ashes are mixed with soil and crops are grown on that area for two to three years. Then the land is abandoned after it loses its fertility and the cultivator moves to a new plot. It is also known as 'slash and burn agriculture'.

Disadvantages of this cultivation are deforestation, losing fertility and soil erosion.

(iv) What is plantation agriculture?

Ans. Plantation is a type commercial farming. In this type of farming, a single crop is grown on a large area. Large amount of capital and labour are required. In India, tea, coffee, rubber, sugarcane, banana etc. are important plantation crops.

(v) Name the fibre crops and name the climatic conditions required for their growth.

Ans. The fibre crops are cotton and jute.

Climatic conditions required for the growth of cotton are high temperature, light rainfall, two hundred ten frost-free days and bright sunshine.

Climatic conditions required for the growth of jute are high temperature, heavy rainfall and humid climate.

Q3. Give reasons.

(i) In India agriculture is a primary activity.

Ans. Agriculture includes growing crops, fruits, vegetables, flowers and rearing of livestock. Two-third of India's population is dependent on agriculture. Hence, it is a primary activity in India.

(ii) Different crops are grown in different regions.

Ans. Different crops are grown in different regions because growing of crops depends on factors such as favourable topography of soil, demand of produce, type of climate, amount of rainfall, technology and labour.

Q4. Distinguish between the followings.

(i) Primary activities and tertiary activities.

Ans.

Primary activities	Tertiary activities
• These activities are connected with extraction and production of natural resources.	• These are those activities which provide support and service to primary and secondary activities.
• These include agriculture, fishing and gathering.	• These include service sector like transport, banking, trade, insurance etc.

(ii) Subsistence farming and intensive farming.

Ans.

Subsistence farming	Intensive farming
• This type of farming is practised to meet the needs of the farmer's family.	• This type of farming is practised to produce food and other crops needed by the local community.
• Low level of technology and household labour are used to produce.	• Simple tools and more labour are used to produce.